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The effect of multidimensions of trust and donors' motivation on donation attitudes and intention toward charitable organizations

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Abstract

This study examined both donors' personal characteristics and the multidimensional attributes of charitable organizations to illuminate how donation intention is formed. The proposed research model was developed based on the theory of planned behavior, and a total of 291 responses were used for empirical analysis. It was found that both altruistic motivation and egoistic motivation have a positive effect on donors' attitudes toward donation. We further found that donation attitudes, subjective norms, and perceived behavioral control all have a positive effect on donation intention. Moreover, the results showed three dimensions of trust in charitable organizations—perceived ability, perceived integrity, and perceived benevolence—positively influence donation attitudes and donation intention. This study's approach is significant because it considers both individual aspects and attributes of charitable organizations as factors leading to donation behavior. We believe that our findings are useful for developing effective fundraising strategies.

KEYWORDS

donation attitudes, donation intention, motivational factors, theory of planned behavior, trust in charity organizations

1 | INTRODUCTION

Today, a person's charitable activities and donations are considered valuable behavior that makes society more sustainable (Ceptureanu et al., 2018; Lee & Jang, 2017; Verhaert & Van den

Poel, 2011). Many organizations and funds have recently been dedicated to charitable giving worldwide. According to Park and Ryu's (2018) research, people come across plenty of donation opportunities or attempts as charitable activities for the cause have become more popular than ever. Giving USA reported that the United States-based charitable organizations (COs) pulled in 326.87 billion dollars in donations in 2021, and individual donors' contributions take up 67% of that total.

Along with favorable sentiment toward donations, charities' fundraising and donation culture have emerged as a social phenomenon. Against this backdrop, the topics related to fundraising efforts, charitable activities, or philanthropy are gaining more attention from researchers (Bekkers & Wiepking, 2011; Chen et al., 2019; Mittelman & Rojas-Mendez, 2018). From an individual's behavioral perspective, earlier studies on donation behavior mentioned a critical role of intrinsic factors because donation behavior was regarded as the result of one's decision, and that decision is influenced by one's psychological traits (Deci, 1971; Madurapperuma & Kim, 2020). From an organizational perspective, the trustworthiness of charities may encourage more donations (Hou et al., 2017; Kirk & Abrahams, 2017). Therefore, we seek to focus on the organizational attributes of charities by examining three components of trust—integrity, ability, and benevolence (Alhidari et al., 2018).

First, it is required to examine a variety of factors to understand the impact on individual donation behavior (Harvey, 1990; Mainardes et al., 2016; Sargeant et al., 2000; Zubairi & Siddiqui, 2019). Prior studies on donation explored different subjects through different methodologies. Since the conditional factors (Darley & Latane, 1968) were suggested as major factors of giving behavior, past research had addressed an individual's altruistic or egoistic motivation (Batson et al., 1981) and focused more on analyzing personal intrinsic factors because donation behavior was believed to be closely related to a person's psychological factors. Since donation behavior is closely related to a person's psychological factors, it is considered a fundamental cause of donation behavior (Myers, 2010). A traditional approach suggested that altruistic motives lead to giving or helping behaviors. However, this is not always true because donation behavior could be caused by selfish motives (Sisco & Weber, 2019). If some people weigh up immediate or long-term gains before engaging in donation behavior, they could be motivated by selfish motives (Brown & Cialdini, 2015; Schroeder & Graziano, 2015).

Several psychologists claimed that people behave in their own interests, which is the basic principle of human behavior. Skinner's (1965) early behaviorism reported that helping acts come from one's selfishness and pursuit of pleasure, and are reinforced by various compensation such as expressing gratitude, compliments from others, feeling of pride, or enhanced reputation. After experiencing such rewards, helping behavior is more encouraged. Since the goal of egoistic helping is to serve the interests of the helper, helping behavior is no more than a way to gain benefits. Conversely, altruistic motives are one's desire to help others and some other benefits the helper may gain from helping are considered secondary.

Most previous studies on donation have primarily focused on altruistic motivation (Bekkers, 2004; Mount, 1996). However, there is a clear contrast between egoistic motivation and altruistic motivation at an individual level. Therefore, the impact of each motivation on donation behavior needs to be analyzed and interpreted from various viewpoints. Reddy (1980) found that an egoistic determinant of donation to charities is tax incentives. Another example shows that where to put a donation box is important. People tend to donate more when the box is located in a busy street than in an empty street. In the same vein, the names of donors are displayed on the walls or designated areas of buildings to acknowledge donors' financial support. Therefore, egoistic motivation can be considered a variable that has a significant impact on donation behavior.

People's perceptions and attitudes are linked to each other, which influences most human behavior (Bandura, 1982; Oosterhof & Todorov, 2009). In the same vein, the degree of perceived trust toward charities can induce positive attitudes, which may affect donation behavior. Therefore, cultivating legitimacy and trust is of utmost importance in allowing charities to achieve their missions and conduct various charitable activities (Becker et al., 2019; Furneaux & Wymer, 2015; Shier & Handy, 2013). What's more, being legitimate and trustworthy can encourage donors to be more dedicated (Peng et al., 2019).

Meanwhile, charity trust varies depending on an individual's belief propensity, so it is required to be studied in multiple dimensions (e.g., perceived ability, perceived integrity, perceived benevolence), not in the existing one-dimensional trust (e.g., Chaudhuri & Holbrook, 2001; Esch et al., 2006; Ha, 2004). In addition, one of the very important points for charities in inducing individual "continuous" donations is that donation attitudes are formed based on multidimensional trust rather than being seen as a commercial image (De Vries et al., 2015; Hyndman & McConville, 2018; Rho et al., 2020).

Thus, it is necessary to focus on the effect of trust in COs on donors' donation attitudes. An individual's attitudes serve as a critical antecedent that induces his/her behavioral intention and positively affects the continuity of intention (Yin et al., 2020). The effect of trust in COs, a factor at an organizational level, on individual donors' donation intention was already examined in the previous research. However, few studies have focused on the effect of trust in COs on donors' donation attitudes.

This study comprehensively investigated two motivational dimensions of donors—altruistic motivation and egoistic motivation—and three components of trust in COs—perceived ability, perceived integrity, and perceived benevolence. By doing so, we aimed to invent the mechanism by which donation attitudes and donation intentions are formed. While most prior studies on donation used the data collected in the United States, the data for this study was gathered from Korea, providing a better understanding of the global donation trend.

To achieve our research purpose, we borrowed a theoretical framework of our research from the theory of planned behavior (TPB). Based on the notion that a person's intention plays a vital role in eliciting a specific behavior (Bilic, 2005), this theory explains that the behavior is performed when a person has the intention and volition to do it. Our approach touching upon the factors affecting an individual's donation intention can contribute to extending the domain of research, and also provide practical guidelines that help facilitate effective donation activities from potential donors.

2 | THEORETICAL BACKGROUND

2.1 | Theory of planned behavior

Behavioral intention is considered the most critical concept in theory of reasoned action (TRA) (Ajzen & Fishbein, 1980) and theory of planned behavior (Ajzen, 1991). It represents the degree of voluntariness and efforts to perform a certain behavior. Since one's behavior is determined by behavioral intention, the two theories suggested that behavioral intention is a predictor of one's future behavior (Luc, 2020).

TPB stated that behavioral intention is determined by three elements—attitudes, subjective norms, and perceived behavioral control. Attitudes toward a behavior are defined as a positive or negative evaluation of a given behavior and are guided by behavioral beliefs and outcome

evaluation (Ajzen, 1985; Ajzen & Madden, 1986). Let us assume that a person would expect a positive outcome caused by his/her donations (including money, time, service, and so on) and consider it significant, which is his/her attitude toward behavior. Behavioral beliefs are one's subjective beliefs about the outcome resulting from a particular behavior, and outcome evaluation represents one's beliefs in evaluating the consequence of a behavior that can be positively or negatively valued. Subjective norms, a social factor determining the intention (Ajzen, 1991; Bayer & Peay, 1997), are defined as an individual's perceived social pressure about one should perform a specific behavior (Ajzen, 1985). For instance, an individual may be likelier to donate if most other people, who are important to him/her, decide to donate. In other words, subjective norms are determined by normative beliefs and motivation to comply, indicating that an individual's behavior is influenced by both his/her evaluation and others' evaluation of particular behaviors. Perceived behavioral control, determined by control beliefs, represents how difficult it is to perform a specific behavior. For example, the decision to donate is entirely up to him/her if an individual is confident to perform a donation behavior, which is the biggest difference from the TRA. TPB defines perceived behavioral control as the extent to which an individual perceives to be able to perform a behavior in a specific situation because TPB assumes that an individual may behave differently in different situations. Therefore, perceived behavioral control is an important addition that helps predict human behavior (Ajzen & Madden, 1986).

TPB has been applicable to extensive research relating to behavior prediction in various disciplines. According to Allport et al. (1954), an attitude is a state of readiness to engage in certain acts or responses. In the same vein, forming a positive attitude and belief toward donation may drive individuals to engage in donation behavior. As with the influence of subjective norms, various information given by others may play as a catalyst or pressure for donation behavior because meeting expectations from significant others can lead to social pressure (Smith & McSweeney, 2007; van der Linden, 2011).

Moreover, people would engage in donation behavior without hesitation when they find giving opportunities, as long as they have the ability to control their behavior. Therefore, individuals' donation behavior can be encouraged by behavioral control (Cronan & Al-Rafee, 2008; Shaw & Shiu, 2003; Veldhuizen et al., 2011). Variables of TPB serve as useful perspectives to discuss an individual's donation behavior. Table 1 shows the list of previous studies on donation.

2.2 | Trust in COs

Trust encompasses diverse concepts and has been defined in different ways by many researchers. Trust is a reliable relationship in which one party believes in another party's words, promises, or fulfillment of duties (Anderson & Weitz, 1989; Moorman et al., 1993; Schurr & Ozanne, 1985). It also represents one party's expectation that another party will not take advantage of the situation or relationship (Gefen et al., 2003). According to prior studies' definitions, trust is the expectation one party has that the other party will act in the interests of trustors (Mayer et al., 1995).

Hansmann (1980) argued that nonprofit organizations provide a better quality of services when information asymmetry exists between consumers and producers because they neither seek profit maximization nor distribute extra income to stakeholders, which makes them more trusted than profit-seeking organizations. In the same vein, potential donors' trust in the CO is the basic condition of getting donations (Tonkiss & Passey, 1999). Potential donors can make donations when they trust that donated money is used wisely and transparently.

TABLE 1 Previous studies on donation using the TPB.

Author/ s(year)	Context	Independent variables	Dependent variables	Additional variables to the TPB, etc.
Soomro et al. (2022)	The study examines recycling intentions and recycling behaviors	Attitude, perceived behavioral control, subjective norm	Recycling intentions, recycling behaviors (such as reusing, reselling, or donating)	Social factors including religion, especially in Islamic countries
Kim and Han (2020)	The study investigates an individual's cognitive and psychological determinants to donate to NPOs (nonprofit organizations) with a positive or negative CEO reputation	Attitude, perceived behavioral control, subjective norm	Intention to donate to NPOs	
Kasri and Ramli (2019)	Surveying the Muslim people, the study investigates donations through Mosques.	Attitude, perceived behavioral control, subjective norm	Donation behavior	Religious beliefs, trust in mosques, ease of donation, etc. are positive for donations
Chen et al. (2019)	A study on crowdfunding platforms and fundraisers	Attitude, perceived behavioral control, subjective norm	Time donations, monetary donations	
Mittelman and Rojas-Mendez (2018)	Based on Canadian charitable donations	Attitude, perceived behavioral control, subjective norm	Donation behavior	
Kashif et al. (2015)	A study on the Collectivism of Kuala Lumpur	Attitude, perceived behavioral control, subjective norm	Donation intention, actual donation behavior	
Kinnally and Brinkerhoff (2013)	A study on the public radio members' donation intention	Attitude, perceived behavioral control, subjective norm	Donation intention	Critical determinant of donation methods (donate by phone or mail)
van der Linden (2011)	Online study about charitable giving. Data were recruited through the university's (London School of Economics) departments and research centers, the experimenter's social network, and through the assistance of various private organizations	Attitude, perceived behavioral control, subjective norm	Donation intention	The past donation experience and moral norms are critical factors inducing donation intention
Smith and McSweeney (2007)	The study was conducted on the general community in Queensland, Australia	Attitude, perceived behavioral control, subjective norm	Donation intention	An individual's altruism and pro-social behavior, which affect donation intention

Therefore, trust in COs refers to beliefs and confidence donors have about charities' activities and the recognition from donors about transparent management of the fund.

Researchers suggested diverse dimensions that constitute the concept of trust (Becker, 2018; Sirdeshmukh et al., 2002). Among them, Alhidari et al. (2018) explained trust in COs based on the three dimensions suggested by Mayer et al. (1995)—integrity, ability, and benevolence. Integrity refers to whether individuals or organizations try to behave according to principles or laws they must follow. In other words, it implies honesty of behaviors. Thus, the integrity of COs represents the belief in their fairness and honesty in fulfilling duties (Mayer et al., 1995). Ability refers to the possession of knowledge, competencies, or skills needed to do something for the trustor in a transaction. When COs are competent, they are believed to have expertise in social welfare and fulfill their obligations effectively (Pavlou & Dimoka, 2006). Benevolence refers to what one party wants to do for the benefit of the other party with good intentions, with no exchange of returns. Those trusted to do their best for those trusting (Mayer et al., 1995), aside from egocentric or selfish motives. In other words, the benevolence of COs is interpreted as the belief in their activities—doing good or getting the right things done for the well-being of society (Mayer et al., 1995; McKnight et al., 2002).

3 | RESEARCH MODEL AND HYPOTHESES DEVELOPMENT

3.1 | Research model

This study considered the perspectives of individual donors and perceptions toward COs together to illuminate the relationship between donation intention and behavior. We identified the antecedents of donation intention based on TPB, then constructed the conceptual model in which the three elements of COs (multidimensional attributes of COs) relate to trust-building, and trust influences donors' attitudes and donation intention. Figure 1 presents the proposed research model of this study.

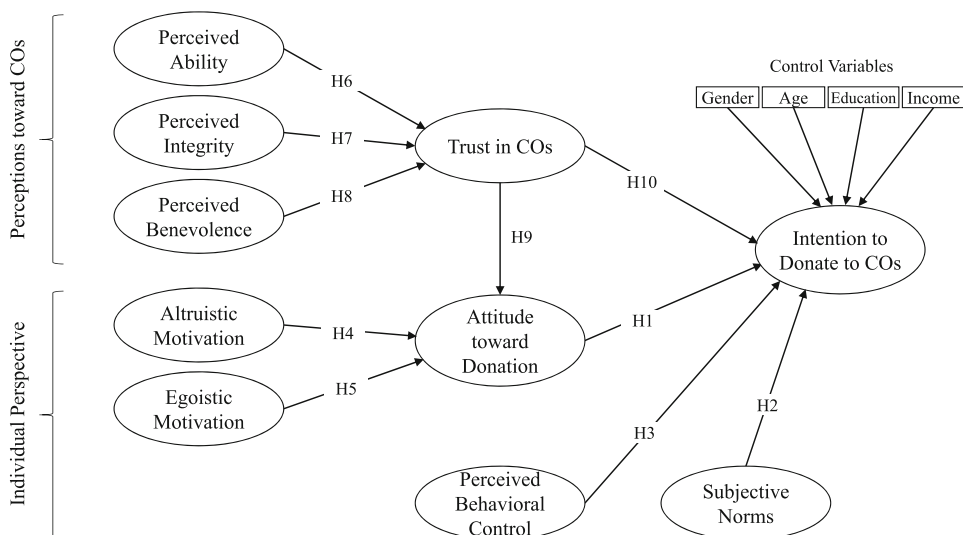


FIGURE 1 Research model.

3.2 | Antecedents of donation intention

The three components reported in TPB—attitudes, subjective norms, and perceived behavioral control—have been widely used to explain an individual's behavioral intention in various disciplines. We adopted TPB to investigate donation behavior by applying three antecedents of donation intention. First, attitudes toward donation refer to being interested in or having the tendency to engage in donation behavior over time (Erlandsson et al., 2018). Directly relating to people's various perceptions, and attitudes influence behavioral intention (Bandura, 1982). In other words, a positive attitude toward donation behavior can directly lead to donation intention (Pauli et al., 2017; Susanto et al., 2021).

Second, subjective norms regarding donation refer to the extent of support from relevant others about donation activities. Prior studies reported that subjective norms closely relate to donation intention. (e.g., Croson et al., 2010; Greenslade & White, 2005). Also, Keating et al. (1981) confirmed that individuals' donation intention varies depending on how much support they get from peers or those around them, and explained that subjective norms can be experienced as coercion.

Lastly, perceived behavioral control is a factor directly influencing behavioral intention (Hsu & Chiu, 2004), thus it is considered the key element of voluntary helping behaviors (Greenslade & White, 2005). Perceived behavioral control regarding donations represents the perception of one's ability to donate and perform a donation behavior (Bouchard & Loehlin, 2001). Since the beliefs in one's financial ability influence donation behavior, the income level relates positively to donation intention, and the current financial constraints are considered a reason for not donating. Also, it is reported that the current income level and the financial status in the future both positively influence attitudes and efforts toward donation (e.g., Edmundson, 1986; Halfpenny, 1990). The perception of one's ability to engage in donation behavior is not only influenced by financial competencies but also by diverse environmental aspects. Self-determination or self-efficacy regarding donations is within the perceived behavioral control that can influence donation intention. Applying three antecedents of behavioral intention suggested in TPB to the context of donations, the following relationship may be presumed;

Hypothesis H1. Attitudes toward donation relate positively to the intention to donate to COs.

Hypothesis H2. Subjective norms relate positively to the intention to donate to COs.

Hypothesis H3. Perceived behavioral control relates positively to the intention to donate to COs.

3.3 | Motivation to donate and attitudes toward donation

Among the three elements influencing behavioral intention, attitudes are formed by behavioral beliefs. The cognitive element (beliefs) affects the emotional element (attitudes), which then affects volitional element (behavioral intention). Consequently, an individual's behavior is the result of all these elements working together (Fishbein & Ajzen, 1975, 1980). Behavioral beliefs

refer to a conviction that a particular behavior will lead to a particular outcome, which is in line with the outcome expectation suggested in social cognitive theory (Bandura, 1986). In other words, behavioral beliefs serve as a motivational element, which may influence an individual's behavior.

Motivation, the underlying reason to establish particular goals that give rise to actions (Deci & Ryan, 1985), refers to the psychological tendency or intrinsic force that causes a person to pursue goals by initiating, eliciting, and maintaining particular behaviors (Petri & Govern, 2005). Motivation for donations has been explored from various perspectives, and it contains both altruistic and egoistic aspects (Bendapudi et al., 1996). Altruistic motivation comes from pure goodwill of helping or benefiting recipients without expecting rewards, whereas egoistic motivation concerns the benefits given back to donors such as social recognition, honor, or respect that donors gain from their actions, tax incentives, etc.

However, motivations for donation are not dichotomized but are located somewhere between altruism and egoism. If there are two closely located on a continuum from altruistic to egoistic, the difference between them would not be noticeable. Although the extremes of altruistic and egoistic motivations are very different, an individual's behavior can fall anywhere on a continuum from altruistic to egoistic. These discussions indicate that donation decisions are made by the intertwined motivation of egoism and altruism, which is consistent with the assumption that all human actions are different depending on situations to serve the best interests (Clary & Snyder, 1999). Several studies also mentioned that egoism and altruism are in contrast, but they can coexist (Yin et al., 2020). Neuroeconomic research using brain imaging techniques reported the activity of VMPFC (Ventromedial prefrontal cortex), a brain region activated when calculating the value associated with one's choice, in assessing the value of donation decisions (Hare et al., 2010). This result indicates that egoistic choice and altruistic choice share the same compensation and value computation mechanisms. What compensation motivates a person to donate to others depends on an individual's choice. A donation motivated by tax incentives is different from an altruism-based donation in terms of motivation, but its outcome may be identical.

For example, people can experience satisfaction, enjoyment, or fulfillment from donations or helping activities. Since these benefits are part of the egoistic achievement, it is hard to conclude that donation behavior is purely driven by altruism (Howard, 1982). In other words, the pursuit of socialization, experience, or enjoyment is the egoistic motivation for volunteering, whereas the desire to help others or return favors belongs to altruistic motivation (Sundeen & Raskoff, 1995). Harbaugh (1998a, 1998b) demonstrated that types of charities' announcements can make a difference in the behavior of donors and the size of donations when the motivation for donation is prestige. He empirically showed that category reporting is effective in raising donations and changing donors' behavior when donors are egoistically motivated by prestige or social status. This result also explains why special events can draw more donors and increase donations. In other words, the more prestige benefits or satisfaction donors enjoy from a fundraising event, the more donations they can make, indicating that benefits gained from interacting with others or social exchange serve as another egoistic motivation for donation (Inoue, 2016).

Helping acts, stemming from an egoistic motive may be the result of calculating gain and loss from helping or not helping others (Piliavin et al., 1981). Therefore, the argument that donation is only driven by altruistic motivation may cause disagreement. Instead, donors may be influenced by altruistic and egoistic motivations in combination (Oh, 2016), and their attitudes, feelings, or tendency about donation, may change. Consequently, we propose the following hypotheses:

Hypothesis H4. Altruistic motivation relates positively to attitudes toward donation.

Hypothesis H5. Egoistic motivation relates positively to attitudes toward donation.

3.4 | Features of COs and formation of trust

Three features of COs—ability, integrity, and benevolence—significantly influence trust in COs (Alhidari et al., 2018). Mayer et al. (1995) also mentioned organizational abilities as the most vital feature in building trust in COs. In social work, the abilities of COs including their administrative skills and expertise in investing or leveraging the donated funds are considered an essential element in attracting donations (Morgan & Hunt, 1994; Pavlou & Dimoka, 2006). Likewise, donors' trust in COs comes from their perception of CO's abilities to allocate and distribute donations correctly and appropriately to those in need. Since COs, like an agency, are responsible for managing and using funds, their abilities are not limited to collecting donations for those in need (Sargeant & Lee, 2002).

Trust in COs represents the extent to which donors are willing to donate money based on the belief that COs' knowledge, expertise, and human resources will be appropriately managed for intended purposes. Therefore, the following hypothesis is proposed:

Hypothesis H6. Perceived ability relates positively to trust in COs.

Another element of trust is integrity which refers to donors' beliefs that COs are dedicated to their role while complying with the principles acceptable to donors (Mayer et al., 1995). In other words, CO's integrity includes being consistent in words and actions and following high ethical standards (Le Berre, 2010). People usually show great concern over the management of funds by COs involved in unethical conduct (van Iwaarden et al., 2009). The amount of donations is clear evidence of the reliability of COs (Sargeant et al., 2006; Tonkiss & Passey, 1999). When donors have trust in COs, they believe that COs are properly protecting and using charitable funds in accordance with ethical missions. Therefore, the following hypothesis is proposed:

Hypothesis H7. Perceived integrity relates positively to trust in COs.

Benevolence refers to the belief in COs doing good for the interests of the public (Mayer et al., 1995; McKnight et al., 2002), not for the benefit of an individual, to promote social welfare. Several studies already reported that benevolence positively influences building trust in COs (Doney & Cannon, 1997). Bennett and Barkensjo (2005) confirmed that charitable acts for those in need help donors trust COs and assess COs they support positively. According to Le Berre (2010), high visibility, commitment to charitable actions, and beneficial achievements contribute to generating donors' perceived benevolence of COs. Based on the previous research, it may be presumed that COs' charitable acts to achieve the cause positively influence trust in COs. Therefore, the following hypothesis is proposed:

Hypothesis H8. Perceived benevolence relates positively to trust in COs.

3.5 | Trust in COs, attitudes toward donation, and intention to donate to COs

Trust in COs, reflecting a positive attitude toward COs, refers to the degree of donors' beliefs that COs are working to serve the public interest as they expect. Previous studies discussed that trust has a positive impact on donors' attitudes toward donation and donation intention (Han, 2004; Lee, 2011).

Social cognitive theory, discussing the interaction between specific human behavior and cognition, asserted that human perceptions and attitudes are interrelated and affect human behavior (Bandura, 1982; Oosterhof & Todorov, 2009). As donating to COs is perceived as moral behavior, a favorable perception about COs is critical in the decision of donations. Positive trust in COs influences motivations and attitudes for donations (Lee & Jang, 2017) and plays a significant role in building a lasting relationship. Long-term fundraising campaigns are mostly based on continued interaction between donors and COs, which results from trust (Kotler & Anderson, 1987). Therefore, trust in COs determines whether it is a good charity or not (Donovan, 2007). For example, Dwyer et al.'s (1987) research showed that those who believe charitable funds are properly used by COs they support are less likely to stop giving even though they face financial or personal constraints. Studies in charity marketing mentioned that high levels of trust in COs relate closely to donors' willingness to continue to donate (e.g., Bekkers, 2003; Saxton, 1995). Furthermore, Burt and Dunham's (2009) research reported that trust in CO's websites correlates significantly with donors' attention to online donations and the amount they donate. Sargeant and Lee (2002) also confirmed that 13 percent of individual donors' donations are subject to change depending on the levels of trust in COs. Moreover, Sargeant and Hudson's (2008) research verified a positive relationship between trust in COs and individuals' donations by showing that donors with high trust in COs are more engaged in giving and volunteering than those with low trust.

Based on previous studies, we presumed how trust in COs relates to attitudes toward donation and donation intention, respectively, as follows.

Hypothesis H9. Trust in COs relates positively to attitudes toward donation.

Hypothesis H10. Trust in COs relates positively to the intention to donate to COs.

4 | METHODS

4.1 | Data collection

Donations take various forms, including money, time, service, or physical goods such as clothing, books, or equipment. Among them, monetary donations are considered the most popular type in South Korea. As the rational choice theory contends (Freeman, 1997), between the two alternatives of donations—giving money or time, Koreans prefer to choose money donations to fulfill their duty as good citizens (Park et al., 2019). A survey reported that the money donation category accounts for 61.6% of all charitable giving made by Koreans (Macromill Embrain Trend Monitor, 2019).

For an empirical verification of the proposed hypotheses, we gathered the data from an online survey conducted for 2 weeks in August 2020. The agency we hired selected Korean

adults aged 19 and older from its pool of verified panelists and 303 respondents who answered that they have ever donated money to Korean charities or understood what charities do complete the questionnaire, yielding a 16.4% response rate. After excluding 12 responses with missing values or invalid answers, a total of 291 were gained for analysis.

As of 2020, the total population of Korea is about 51.9 Mil. The population by generation is 8.8 Mil under the age of 20, 6.8 Mil in their 20s, 6.9 Mil in their 30s, 8.3 Mil in their 40s, 8.6 Mil in their 50s, and 12.5 Mil in their 60s and older (Ministry of Public Administration and Security, 2020). According to the distribution of donations by generation in 2020, out of the total donation population of 960,509, those under the age of 30 were the smallest at 25,920, with 112,654 in their 30s, 238,287 in their 40s, 304,291 in their 50s, and 226,511 in their 60s and older (Tax Statistics Information, 2020). Table 2 displays the demographic characteristics of respondents.

To avoid nonresponse bias, we conducted a *t*-test after dividing the respondents into two groups—those who participated in the survey during the previous week and those who did in the following week. The results showed no statistically significant difference between the two groups ($\chi^2 = 2.69$, $p = 0.27$), confirming no issues caused by nonresponse bias in this study (Hair et al., 1998).

4.2 | Measures

All measurement items in this study were drawn from previous studies. We drew the items to assess variables related to an individual donor’s perspective based on the main three concepts of

TABLE 2 Characteristics of the respondents (*N* = 291).

Criteria		Freq.	%	Criteria		Freq.	%	
Gender	Male	149	51.2	Marital	Married	191	65.6	
	Female	142	48.8		Not married	94	32.3	
Age	Under 20s	5	1.7	Job	Etc.	6	2.1	
	20s	35	12.0		Employee	135	46.4	
	30s	75	25.8		Public official	15	5.2	
	40s	52	17.9		Specialized job	18	6.2	
	50s	97	33.3		Self-employment	24	8.2	
	60s or above	27	9.3		Etc.	99	34.0	
Education	Highschool	80	27.5	Religion	Christian	72	24.7	
	College	29	10.0		Buddhism	44	15.1	
	University	163	56.0		Catholic	31	10.7	
	Graduate	19	6.5		None	143	49.1	
Income	Under \$1Mil.	50	17.2	Recent Donation Experience	Etc.	1	0.3	
	\$1 ~ 2Mil.	36	12.4		None	62	21.3	
	\$2 ~ 3Mil.	72	24.7		5 years ago	74	25.4	
	\$3 ~ 4Mil.	51	17.5		3 ~ 4 years ago	37	12.7	
	\$4 ~ 5Mil.	38	13.1		1 ~ 2 years ago	46	15.8	
	\$5Mil. Or above	44	15.1		Within 1 year	72	24.7	

TABLE 3 Reliability and validity of construct measurements.

Items	Loading	α	CR	AVE
Perceived ability (PA)				
I believe that COs have the ability to safeguard my donated money	0.835	0.799	0.856	0.502
I believe that COs understand the needs of the beneficiaries	0.632			
I believe that COs have the ability to conduct various activities	0.603			
I believe that COs are competent and effective in conducting their activities	0.681			
I believe that COs have the ability to solve problems they face	0.640			
I believe that the COs use donated funds properly	0.823			
Perceived integrity (PI)				
I believe that COs are honest	0.802	0.804	0.864	0.561
I believe that COs are truthful in working with the donors	0.719			
I believe that COs fulfill their roles consistently to achieve their goals	0.648			
I believe that COs behave ethically	0.799			
I believe that COs will keep their promises	0.764			
Perceived benevolence (PB)				
I believe that COs prioritize the best interests of the beneficiaries	0.691	0.711	0.823	0.539
I believe that COs ask donors for appropriate amount of donation all the time	0.651			
I believe that COs inform donors of how the donated money is used	0.815			
I believe that COs promptly respond to questions or concerns that donors have	0.770			
Altruistic motivation (AM)				
Donating to COs enables me to advance social justice	0.728	0.845	0.882	0.516
Donating to COs enables me to keep social norms	0.681			
Donating to COs enables me to fulfill social responsibilities	0.669			
Donating to COs enables me to give back to the community where I live	0.769			
Donating to COs is a meaningful way to contribute to the community	0.719			
Donating to COs is a good opportunity to help others	0.755			
Donating to COs will impact the community for the better	0.704			
Egoistic motivation (EM)				
Donating to COs will give me a sense of self-fulfillment	0.756	0.757	0.846	0.581
Donating to COS will give me pleasure	0.808			
Donating to COs will make me feel needed	0.805			
Donating to COs will make me feel that I am doing something worthwhile	0.672			
Trust in COs (TCO)				
COs are trustworthy	0.938	0.899	0.937	0.832

TABLE 3 (Continued)

Items	Loading	α	CR	AVE
COs are reliable organizations	0.924			
I have confidence in COs	0.873			
Subjective norms (SN)				
Most people important to me think that I ought to make charitable donations	0.814	0.740	0.852	0.658
Most people important to me think that my donating to COs would be desirable	0.772			
Most people important to me want me to make charitable donations	0.846			
Perceived behavioral control (PBC)				
If I want to, I am confident that I will be able to donate money to COs in the near future	0.706	0.712	0.838	0.634
If I want to, donating money to COs in the near future is easy for me to do	0.841			
If I want to, it is entirely up to me whether I donate money to COs in the near future	0.834			
Attitudes toward donation (AD)				
Helping others by donating to COs is good	0.880	0.899	0.930	0.768
Helping others by donating to COs is a pleasant experience	0.863			
Helping others by donating to COs is a worthwhile experience	0.907			
Helping others by donating to COs is wise behavior	0.853			
Intention to donate to COs (ID)				
If I can, I intend to make charitable donations in the near future	0.884	0.876	0.916	0.732
I am highly likely to make charitable donations in the near future	0.900			
I will make charitable donations in the near future	0.888			
I will recommend others around me make charitable donations	0.740			

Abbreviations: AVE, average variance extracted; α , Cronbach's α ; CR, composite reliability.

TPB (attitudes, subjective norms, and perceived behavioral control) (Ajzen & Fishbein, 1980). As for the intention to donate to COs, we leveraged the items of Bock et al. (2005). The items for altruistic motivation and egoistic motivation were drawn from Dolnicar and Randle's (2007) research and Sargeant's (2001) research. The three elements of trust in COs—ability, integrity, and benevolence—were measured with the items drawn from Alhidari et al.'s (2018) work. The final questionnaire contains 43 questions on a five-point Likert scale. As for demographic items, gender, age, education, and monthly income were widely used as factors affecting the intention to donate in previous research, thus we adopted them along with job and recent donation experience. Furthermore, marital status and religion were added as socio-demographic items because the former is a factor related to income or financial ability that may affect perceived behavioral control and the latter may affect motivational factors.

TABLE 4 Pearson of correlation.

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)	(13)	(14)
(1) Perceived ability	1													
(2) Perceived integrity	.723**	1												
(3) Perceived benevolence	.678**	.671**	1											
(4) Altruistic motivation	.373**	.349**	.436**	1										
(5) Egoistic motivation	.347**	.312**	.357**	.709**	1									
(6) Trust in COs	.692**	.679**	.687**	.411**	.448**	1								
(7) Subjective norms	.345**	.353**	.326**	.302**	.311**	.449**	1							
(8) Perceived behavioral control	.204**	.243**	.322**	.369**	.318**	.252**	.156**	1						
(9) Attitudes toward donation	.347**	.314**	.350**	.603**	.642**	.415**	.228**	.392**	1					
(10) Intention to donate to COs	.322**	.331**	.438**	.476**	.565**	.504**	.421**	.407**	.594**	1				
(11) Gender	.007	.095	−.055	.204	.209	.014	.312*	−.154	−.021	−.192	1			
(12) Age	.329*	.214	.221	−.031	−.032	.310*	−.053	.102	−.022	.126	−.302*	1		
(13) Education	−.067	−.081	−.038	.085	.125*	.019	.180**	.070	.114	.143*	.157	−.157	1	
(14) Income	−.004	−.036	.007	.081	.123*	.102	.176**	.071	.080	.190**	−.034	.070	.403**	1
Mean	2.810	2.726	2.714	2.952	2.987	2.619	2.651	2.983	3.276	2.801	1.420	43.560	2.416	3
S.D.	.676	.745	.687	.780	.805	.852	.794	.879	.733	.818	.499	11.617	.963	2

Note: N = 291.
* $p < 0.05$; ** $p < 0.01$ (two-tailed test).

TABLE 5 Results of heterotrait–monotrait ratio (HTMT) analysis.

	AD	AM	EM	ID	SN	PA	PB	PI	PBC	TCO
AD										
AM	0.741									
EM	0.830	0.833								
ID	0.733	0.552	0.696							
SN	0.347	0.381	0.420	0.520						
PA	0.423	0.451	0.450	0.382	0.448					
PB	0.500	0.565	0.489	0.555	0.446	0.847				
PI	0.403	0.423	0.398	0.393	0.457	0.849	0.837			
PBC	0.521	0.473	0.432	0.516	0.216	0.271	0.453	0.321		
TCO	0.519	0.472	0.547	0.567	0.553	0.814	0.810	0.796	0.311	

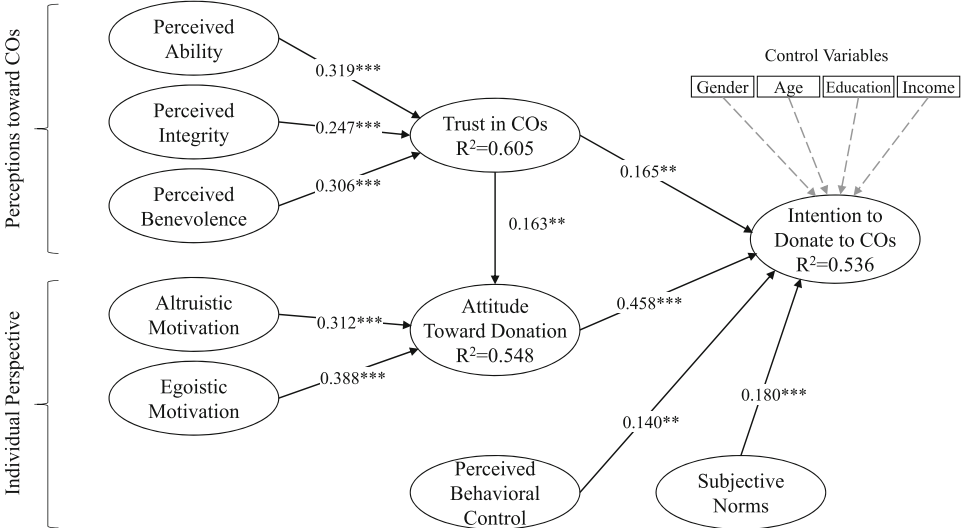


FIGURE 2 Result of structural model test. * $p < 0.05$, ** $p < 0.01$, *** $p < 0.001$.

5 | ANALYSES AND RESULTS

5.1 | Measurement model testing

The KMO Index was 0.977 and the Bartlett's Test of Sphericity was 0.001, both indicating that the data used in this study were adequate for factor analysis. We used SPSS to perform a principal component analysis with varimax rotation and excluded six items with factor loadings below 0.5 (Bagozzi & Yi, 1988). Table 3 shows correlations among variables, values of average and standard deviation.

Then, we assessed the reliability, convergent validity, and discriminant validity of variables to verify whether the proposed model measures a construct consistently and accurately. Table 4 contains the values of Crobach's alpha coefficient, composite reliability (CR), and average

variance extracted (AVE). As for all items, Cronbach's alpha values are greater than 0.7 (Hair et al., 2011), CR values are above 0.7 (Chin, 1998) and AVE values are above 0.5 (Fornell & Larcker, 1981), indicating the model fulfills an acceptable threshold of reliability and convergent validity. Table 5 shows that the heterotrait–monotrait of all variables are below 0.85, indicating that the model has sufficient discriminant validity (Henseler et al., 2015).

Next, we conducted Harman's single-factor test to estimate the common method bias (Podsakoff & Organ, 1986). When all the variables were entered into principal component analysis, 10 distinct factors with an eigenvalue greater than 1.0 were present and the first factor did not take up a majority of the total variance. Thus, the common method bias is unlikely to have a serious impact on the interpretation of results.

5.2 | Structural model testing

Figure 2 contains the results of structural model testing using smartPLS 3.3.1.

First, attitudes toward donation ($\beta = 0.458$, $t = 8.323$), subjective norms ($\beta = 0.180$, $t = 3.967$), and perceived behavioral control ($\beta = 0.140$, $t = 2.926$) have a statistically significant influence on donation intention. These results indicate that H1, H2, and H3 are supported. Second, both altruistic motivation ($\beta = 0.312$, $t = 4.425$) and egoistic motivation ($\beta = 0.388$, $t = 5.800$) have a statistically significant influence on attitudes toward donation, which supports H4 and H5. From the perceptions toward COs, the results reveal that trust in CO is significantly influenced by perceived ability ($\beta = 0.319$, $t = 4.518$), integrity ($\beta = 0.247$, $t = 3.570$), and benevolence ($\beta = 0.306$, $t = 4.810$) of COs. Furthermore, trust in COs significantly influence donation attitudes ($\beta = 0.163$, $t = 2.992$) and intention ($\beta = 0.165$, $t = 2.917$). These findings indicate that the hypotheses from H6 to H10 are all supported.

Hence, all the 10 hypotheses were supported and the lowest R-square value of the intrinsic variables was 53.6%, which was at a higher level, indicating that the model explains the data

TABLE 6 Summary of the results.

Hypotheses	Path coefficient	Result
H1 Attitudes toward donation relate positively to intention to donate to COs.	0.458***	Supported
H2 Subjective norms relate positively to intention to donate to COs.	0.180***	Supported
H3 Perceived behavioral control relates positively to intention to donate to COs.	0.140**	Supported
H4 Altruistic motivation relates positively to attitudes toward donation.	0.312***	Supported
H5 Egoistic motivation relates positively to attitudes toward donation.	0.388***	Supported
H6 Perceived ability relates positively to trust in COs.	0.319***	Supported
H7 Perceived integrity relates positively to trust in COs.	0.247***	Supported
H8 Perceived benevolence relates positively to trust in COs.	0.306***	Supported
H9 Trust in COs relates positively to attitudes toward donation.	0.163**	Supported
H10 Trust in COs relates positively to intention to donate to COs.	0.165**	Supported

** $p < 0.01$; *** $p < 0.001$.

adequately. As for control variables, we found that gender, age, education, and income have no statistically significant influence on the dependent variable, which differs from earlier studies. There might be various reasons for such contradiction. One plausible explanation is that the proposed model considers multiple variables in terms of individual perspectives and perceptions toward COs simultaneously, which makes variables' relative impact weak, compared to their direct impact. Table 6 shows the summary of the hypotheses test results.

6 | DISCUSSION

6.1 | Summary of findings and implications

This study primarily examined what impact donors' trust in COs and attitudes toward donation have on donation intention. Here is a summary of our findings.

First, built upon TPB, we considered attitudes, subjective norms, and perceived behavioral control as the antecedents of individuals' donation intention. Attitudes, and emotional responses to an object (Ajzen & Fishbein, 1980), were identified as the factor that has a critical influence on donation intention. In other words, an individual's positive or negative feeling toward donations leads to a vast difference in donation intention. Subjective norms are defined as the aggregate of social pressures to conform with the expectations of others who are important to a person. They guide a person to behave in a certain manner (Ajzen, 1991), which is consistent with the finding of this study; an individual's subjective norms positively influenced donation intention. Like Martin and Randal's (2008) experiment of a transparent donation box, the behavior, support, or approval of important others serves as the subjective norms that determine an individual's behavior. As well, this study found that one's perceived behavioral control positively influences donation intention. Perceived behavioral control consists of subjective beliefs in one's ability to perform a behavior effectively and one's drive to engage in a particular behavior. Thus, positively perceived behavioral control is more likely to generate donation intention, which is in line with the previous research (i.e., Ajzen & Madden, 1986).

Second, this study confirmed that altruistic motivation and egoistic motivation both positively influence attitudes toward donation, which is at odds with many previous studies that reported a more significant impact of donors' altruistic motivation. As Howard (1982) discussed, decision-making is based on a utility function used in a given situation; for instance, people judge their options based on a different utility function depending on whether it is a private or public matter. When it comes to donation, altruistic motivation refers to the desire to enhance the public good, and egoistic motivation is described as the desire to get rewards from giving. Both motivations play a positive role in motivating donation behavior (Steinberg, 1987). Likewise, this study found that a mix of motivations—egoism and altruism—positively encourages charitable giving and volunteering.

Third, this study revealed that the three features of COs – ability, integrity, and benevolence—have a significant influence on trust in COs, which is consistent with Alhidari et al.'s (2018) research. Since COs are responsible for ensuring that money donated is properly managed and used, their performance is one of the criteria that can sustain trust from donors. CO's integrity refers to the extent to which COs behave consistently to serve their mission, vision, and values. As a recent rise in charity-related fraud leads to the need for the committee supervising COs, integrity is an essential factor in building donors' trust in COs. CO's

benevolence refers to CO's willingness that affects donors' beliefs (Mayer et al., 1995). When COs are committed to doing good for the public interest, donors have positive beliefs in COs.

Fourth, we found that trust in COs is a critical factor that has a positive influence on donation attitudes and donation intention. In other words, higher trust in COs leads to a positive attitude toward the nonprofit sector, which provides a solid foundation for a mature philanthropic culture (Bekkers, 2003).

Here is a summary of the theoretical implications of this study: First, this study derived the antecedents of donors' donation intention based on TPB and integrated them into three components of trust in COs. This approach is an extension of TPB by adding a comprehensive perspective to understanding the mechanisms of donation behavior.

Second, this study demonstrated that trust in COs leads to positive attitudes and intentions toward donation. As the multi-dimensional attributes of COs are the foundation for building trust in COs, they are the standard that shows how reliable the organizations are. Also, they are the objective criteria to evaluate COs because COs' attributes reflect various factual information on COs (Uslaner & Brown, 2005). Even when the expected consequences of donations are uncertain, trustworthiness of COs plays a significant role in maintaining a good relationship between donors and COs (Eggers et al., 2013; Gefen & Straub, 2004). Therefore, this study implies that trust in charities can increase optimism toward the charitable sector, contributing to strengthening the public trust in the sector and making society mature (Bekkers, 2003).

Third, this study tried to reflect on what drives individual donors to help others by considering a complementary interplay between altruistic and egoistic motivation. Prior studies before the 1990s reported that the nominal reasons for donating mostly come from altruism (Batson et al., 1981; Macaulay & Leonard, 1970), but it is also true that donors decide to donate for personal benefits, such as inner satisfaction from feeling good, improved recognition or reputation (Eisenberger et al., 1990; Rousseau & Parks, 1993). Hence, charities need to appeal to both emotion and reason to induce long-term giving from donors (Drucker, 1990).

Finally, we took a comprehensive approach by studying individual perspectives and perceptions toward COs combined and suggested four variables—trust in COs, attitudes toward donation, perceived behavioral control, and subjective norms—as the antecedents that directly affect donation intention. We compared the path coefficients, standardized values calculated through PLS-SEM, and the four paths between each variable and the dependent variable were statistically significant. Among them, the impact of attitudes was the greatest. Furthermore, trust in COs had an indirect impact on donation intention by way of attitudes. These results show that this study empirically verified the role of attitudes.

As for practical implications, this study suggested that three features of COs (multi-dimensional attributes of COs) are the antecedents of trust-building of donors, which provides guidelines that help COs operate effectively and transparently. We confirmed that donors' trust in COs' dedication to their roles honestly and fairly directly leads to generating donation intention, thereby promoting more donations from donors. COs are more trusted overall as they are believed to better distribute public goods or services in a situation of information asymmetry, and that's why COs' influence on social service or medical service has been significant (Hansmann, 1980). However, various unethical scandals have undermined public trust in COs. Against this backdrop, this finding implies the need for informing donors of what COs are doing continuously and transparently. For example, nonprofits are increasingly leveraging videos to publicize their activities and communicate with their supporters. A website or SNS platform is another tool to let donors know where their money is going and how the money is used. By providing donors with accurate information promptly, COs can build a relationship of

trust and integrity with their donors. To conclude, there is no better way to retain donors and keep giving than by being transparent and implementing innovative ideas to achieve their cause.

6.2 | Limitations and future research

We recognize that this study has some limitations that need to be overcome in future studies. First, we considered the independent variables of this study based on two different dimensions—individual donors' perspectives and CO's organizational attributes. However, donation intention may be influenced by various factors including donors' behavioral factors. Also, the influence of other external factors cannot be ruled out, including nonprofit brand image (Michel & Rieunier, 2012), emotions used in charities' advertising appeals (Kandrack & Lundberg, 2014; Small & Verrochi, 2009), moral identity (Reed et al., 2007; Reed & Aquino, 2003), and characteristics of beneficiaries (Smith et al., 2013). Especially, the impact of donation motivations can vary depending on an individual's empathizing ability (Batson, 2011) or happiness level (Batson et al., 2015; Thoits & Hewitt, 2001). Thus, future studies need to explore donations motivated by genuine egoism or altruism and how those motivations are formed.

Second, COs have recently offered various ways of donating to build a culture of philanthropy. For example, donating intangible assets like time or offering special skills pro bono is considered valuable as cash donations. However, few attempts have been made to research these kinds of donations (Chen et al., 2019). In particular, time donations are conducted differently from financial giving because time is an irreversible asset, and time donations happen regularly. Therefore, new and innovative means of giving need to be addressed theoretically in future studies.

Lastly, this study only measured donation intention, not tracking whether it leads to donation behavior or how long it is sustained. Although donation intention was mentioned as a critical antecedent of donation behavior in several studies (Ahn et al., 2018; Kashif et al., 2015; Smith & McSweeney, 2007), it is hard to ignore the intention-behavior gap completely because various other factors may affect the transition from intention to behavior (Sheeran, 2002). Therefore, future studies will be able to provide useful insights into the operation of COs if they focus more on how the intention leads to donation behavior.

DATA AVAILABILITY STATEMENT

Research data are not shared.

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